VERBAL

Critical Reasoning

(Strengthening, Weakening & Wrong assumptions)

Assignment 04

hitbullseye

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 1

A few states in this country are considering legislation that would prohibit schools from using calculators before the sixth grade. Other states take a different position. Some states are insisting on the purchase of graphing calculators for every student in middle school.

This paragraph best supports the statement that in this country

A) there are at least two opinions about the use of calculators in schools.
B) calculators and other devices are frequently a detriment to learning Maths.
C) state legislators are more involved in education and training than ever before.
D) the price of graphing calculators is less when schools buy them in bulk.

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 2

Generation Xers are those people born roughly between 1965 and 1981. As employees, Generation Xers tend to be more challenged when they can carry out tasks independently. This makes Generation the most entrepreneurial generation in history.

This paragraph best supports the statement that Generation Xers

A) work harder than people from other generations. B) have a tendency to be self-directed workers
C) have an interest in making history of good work D) tend to work in jobs that require risk-taking behaviour.

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 3

In the past, consumers would rarely walk into an ice cream store and order low-fat ice cream. But that isn't the case today. An increasing health consciousness combined with a much bigger selection of tasty low-fat foods in all categories has made low-fat ice cream a very profitable item for ice cream store owners.

This paragraph best supports the statement that-

A) low-fat ice cream produces more revenue than other low-fat foods and beverages.
B) ice cream store owners would be better off carrying only low-fat ice cream.
C) ice cream store owners no longer think that low-fat ice cream is an unpopular item.
D) low-fat ice cream is more popular than other kinds of ice cream.

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 4

If you're a fitness walker, there is no need for a commute to a health club. Your neighborhood can be your health club. You don't need a lot of fancy equipment to get a good workout, either. All you need is a well-designed pair of athletic shoes.

This paragraph best supports the statement that-

A) fitness walking is a better form of exercise than weight lifting and work out at gym.
B) a membership in a health club is a poor investment.
C) walking outdoors provides a better workout than walking indoors.
D) fitness walking is a convenient and valuable form of exercise.

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 5

Inevitably one day an asteroid will be discovered to be on a collision course with earth. As soon as its path can be reliably predicted, plans will be put into action to attempt to deflect it, and astronomers have a number of methods in mind for doing this. Blowing the asteroid to pieces with nuclear weapons is not the answer because this would not alter the orbit of the fragments — instead of coming towards us as cannonball, it would be transformed into buckshot. Exploding nuclear weapons some way above the asteroid's surface might be a more successful, if tricky option.

What would be the best explanation for the success of using the explosion-above- the-surface option?

A) Some of the rocks would be melted and would release gases to nudge the asteroid into a safe orbit
B) Exploding nuclear weapons above the asteroid's surface will demolish the asteroid completely
C) When huge nuclear weapons are exploded near the asteroid, instead of buckshot, the asteroid is transformed into very small fragments the size of pebbles
D) Some asteroids contain water. On explosion of nuclear weapons, this water is converted to steam and the asteroid gets vaporised

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 6

Moore's law is a statement saying that the performance of integrated circuits doubles every eighteen months. Intel spent billions of dollars doing that. If they didn't have Moore's law, they wouldn't have that advancement.

The argument above assumes that

A) Moore's law was more a managerial tool than a technical law
B) The technological limits to the number of transistors per square unit area had not been reached
C) If you don't grow, you'll regress D) Where there is a will, there is a way

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 7

You don't have to study what interests the couples share in common or how they were raised or any of a thousand different ways they treat each other. Merely watch how they argue. If Markman and his colleagues can watch a couple for just 15 minutes and focus on their reactivity and pre-dispositive responsiveness, they can predict with 90 percent accuracy who will and who won't be together and happy five years later! During those 15 minutes, Markman will invite a couple to discuss some topic about which they disagree.

What kind of behavior would you expect from a couple which is built to last?

A) They discuss the topic, taking care to be sensitive about the partner's viewpoint.
B) They typically have a dominant spouse who takes control and thus they never argue.
C) They avoid the topic altogether and the 'elephant in the room' is always ignored.
D) They discuss the topic but stay firm on their point, which shows their beliefs in honest communication.

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 8

We are used to the idea of a planet orbiting a star but that is only half the story; just as the star pulls the planet into an orbit, so the planet pulls back on the star. But because the star is so much more massive, the planet cannot cause the star to move through a large orbit; instead, it makes the star wobble. Take for example, our largest planet Jupiter. The Sun pulls it around its 750-million kilometer (466-million-mile) orbit in twelve Earth years. In the same time, all Jupiter can manage is to force the Sun to pirouette about a point approximately 50,000 kilometers (31,000 miles) above the fiery surface. Such a pirouette is the periodic wobble that astronomers look for when searching other stars for planets. The size of the star's movement and the time it takes to complete one wobble allows astronomers to compute the mass and orbital radius of the unseen planet. The surprise is that instead of finding slow pirouettes like the Sun's that take years, most of the wobbling stars found so far complete their orbits in a matter of days.

What inference can we make about the wobbling stars?

A) This indicates that the planets are larger than the wobbling stars.
B) This indicates that the speed of the stars is slowing down.
C) This indicates that the planets orbit very close to the wobbling stars.
D) This indicates the presence of a black hole near the wobbling star.

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 9

Political turmoil in a country is mainly caused by widespread violence and flawed economic policies of successive governments. If at all this has to be crushed, it can be achieved only by a dictatorial government which rules with iron hand. Therefore, the need of the hour is to elect a government which imposes fresh set of stringent legislations.
The alternatives suggested (not necessarily all), if true, considerably weaken the argument. However, one of them is most forceful. Identify the same.

A) It is not the imposition of new legislation; which is required, but effective adherence to the existing legislations.
B) That government is the best government which governs least.
C) It is possible to overcome any evil by educating people.
D) Only dialogue in a free society can eradicate political turmoil.

DIRECTION for the question: *Answer the question based on the information given in the passage.*

Question No. : 10

Political turmoil in a country is mainly caused by widespread violence and flawed economic policies of successive governments. If at all this has to be crushed, it can be achieved only by a dictatorial government which rules with iron hand. Therefore, the need of the hour is to elect a government which imposes fresh set of stringent legislations.

Under the same fact situation as above, the alternatives suggested (not necessarily all), if true, significantly strengthen the argument. However, one of them is most forceful. Identify the same.

A) Espionage activities by enemy nations, which contribute to political turmoil, can be prevented only if the government is very strong.
B) The philosophy behind any economic policy, push from bottom, press from top' is to be followed to mitigate violence, and it is not observed.
C) Political turmoil is due to corrupt establishment.
D) Man is, by nature, a beast.

QNo:- 1 ,Correct Answer:- *A*

Explanation:-
The paragraph clearly states that ***there are two differing opinions with regard to the use of calculators in the classroom****.*
Option A *is the correct answer.*

Although some people may believe that option B is true, the paragraph does not indicate this.
Option C has no relation to the paragraph.
Option D makes logical sense, but the paragraph says nothing about cost.

QNo:- 2 ,Correct Answer:- *B*

Explanation:-
It is clear from the 2nd line "As employees, Generation Xers tend to be more challenged when they can carry out tasks independently"
Generation Xers *like to work independently, which means they* ***are self-directed****.*
Hence ***option B*** *is the correct choice*

No support is given for either option A or C.
Option D is not related to the paragraph.

QNo:- 3 ,Correct Answer:- *C*

Explanation:-
Option C *is the only appropriate of the given options because the paragraph indicates that low-fat ice cream was once an unpopular item, but now, as consumers are more health conscious and there is a wider array of tasty low-fat foods, low-fat ice cream is a profitable item for ice cream store owners.*

There is no indication that choices A, B or D are true based on the information given

QNo:- 4 ,Correct Answer:- *D*

Explanation:-
Option D *is the right answer*
By stating that fitness walking does not require a commute to a health club, the author stresses the convenience of this form of exercise.
The paragraph also states that fitness walking will result in a good workout.
Option A is incorrect because no comparison to weight lifting is made.
Option B may seem like a logical answer, but the paragraph only refers to people who are fitness walkers, so for others, a health club might be a good investment.
Option C is not in the passage.

QNo:- 5 ,Correct Answer:- *A*

Explanation:-
Option A is correct*. Newton's3rd law of motion states that for every action there's an equal and opposite reaction. Thus, when a nuclear explosion takes place above the surface, it creates a natural 'rocket' engine and deflects the asteroid into a different orbit.*

Option B is incorrect because it is vague.
Option C is again incorrect because the size of the nuclear weapon is hardly the concern here and if it could be done then it would've been done.
Option D is ruled out because even if this theory was true, the key word would be "some". How do you know for sure if the asteroid contains water or not? Hence, ruled out.

QNo:- 6 ,Correct Answer:- *A*

Explanation:-
A combined reading of the second and third line of the argument tells us that Intel spent a lot of money to double its chips computing capacity every 18 months. It also tells us that this was an internal target at Intel – so they ended up achieving it. ***This makes it more of a managerial tool.***

Option B is correct – but the argument has a non-technical context, hence we cannot say that this is the assumption it calls for.
Options C and D are general truisms, which can at best be seen as inferences, not assumptions.

QNo:- 7 ,Correct Answer:- *A*

Explanation:-
Option A is correct *because the spouses need to be sensitive to each other's viewpoints to have a successful relationship. The key phrase to establish this answer option is: their reactivity and pre-dispositive responsiveness.*

Option B is incorrect because a dominant-subservient relationship can never hold in the long term.
Option C is ruled out because ignoring the topic will hardly cause it to go away.
Option D is wrong because, while honest communication is important, we need to compromise on a few things to make a marriage work.

QNo:- 8 ,Correct Answer:- *C*

Explanation:-
Option A is incorrect because then the star would rotate through a large orbit around the planet instead of vice versa. Hence, ruled out.
Option B is incorrect because the wobbling has nothing to do with the speed of the star.
Option D is incorrect as black hole has nothing to do with what the author states in the passage.

Option C is correct *as a shorter orbit would result in a shorter time required for completion of the orbit. Hence, the wobbling too would be of a smaller duration.*

QNo:- 9 ,Correct Answer:- *B*

Explanation:-
The argument bases itself on the premise that political turmoil is caused by violence and the government policies.
It concludes that a dictatorial government which rules strictly and imposes stringent regulations can crush political turmoil.

Option A does not weaken the argument much because it is not clear from the passage that existing legislations would be effective in curbing political turmoil.
Option C talks about educating people which may weaken the argument somewhat but still does not address whether a strict government would be required or not.
Option D also talks about the effectiveness of dialogue and that too in a certain type of society i.e. 'free' society.

Only ***option B*** *if true would directly* ***weakens*** *the need for a strict government which rules dictatorially as the government will not be interfering much and can still be termed as weak*

QNo:- 10 ,Correct Answer:- *B*

Explanation:-
*Only **option B**, which mentions the economic policy of 'press from top' broadly **strengthens** the case for a dictatorial government which imposes strict rules from above. It also talks about 'economics' stregthening the link the Q even further*

*Option A talks about only one factor (espionage activities by enemy nations) that affects political turmoil and does not strengthen the conclusion that much as Q states "Political turmoil in a country is **mainly caused by** widespread violence and flawed economic policies"*
Option C which talks about 'corrupt establishment' also does not directly strengthen the case for a tough government. Even a dictatorial government can be corrupt
Option D makes a far-fetched statement not related to the issue at all.